

Syllabus

CS 540: Data Literacy and Visualization

Course Prerequisites

CS 500

Course Description

In this course, students will examine the fundamental concepts and practical skills related to data literacy and data visualization. They will learn to apply data blending principles to merge multiple data sources, create insightful visualizations, and utilize data storytelling techniques to optimize the effectiveness of visualizations. Topics include data collection, cleaning, analysis, visualization principles, and practical applications. Students will also develop skills in generating and communicating actionable and informative data insights that can be leveraged by various clients and stakeholders for making informed decisions across a range of practical and professional contexts.

Course Competencies

This course covers the following competencies, which represent the knowledge and skills relevant to your field:

- CS-53979: Gather data required for informing organizational decision-making processes
- CS-53980: Create data visualizations appropriate for revealing key data insights
- CS-53981: Use data visualizations in the support of a data-driven narrative

Required Materials

Using your learning resources is critical to your success in this course. Please purchase directly through the [SNHU Online Bookstore](#) rather than any other vendor. Purchasing directly from the bookstore ensures that you will obtain the correct materials and that the IT Service Desk, your advisor, and the instructor can provide you with support if you have problems.

Data Literacy and Visualization

zyBooks

2025

zyBooks

To access your zyBooks resource, complete the steps outlined in the Start Here area of the course.

Codio

This course uses Codio, a cloud-based learning environment. For further information on using this resource, review the Codio Student Guide in the Codio area of the course.

Git and GitHub

This course uses Git and GitHub. Instructions for accessing these resources are provided in the GitHub Portfolio area of your course.

Technical Requirements

Make sure you've met the [technical requirements](#) to complete this course.

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

As indicated in our core values, SNHU is committed to “embrace diversity where we encourage and respect diverse identities, ideas, and perspectives by honoring difference, amplifying belonging, engaging civilly, and breaking down barriers to bring our mission to life.”

This may or will be reflected in SNHU’s curriculum as we embrace and practice diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) to provide the most transformative experience for our students, faculty, and staff. Because topics pertaining to DEI can be sensitive, please remember that embodying and practicing diversity, equity, and inclusion is one of our core values that you will encounter throughout the academic experience. In higher education, we are expected to think and engage critically. Use a growth mindset to embrace the diverse readings, course assignments, and experiences of your peers and faculty.

For more information about DEI at SNHU, please visit our website at the [Office of Diversity and Inclusion](#).

Instructor Availability and Response Time

Your class interaction with the instructor and your classmates will take place on a regular, ongoing basis. Your instructor will be actively engaged within the course throughout the week.

You will normally communicate with your instructor in the weekly discussions or the General Questions discussion topic so that your questions and the instructor's answers benefit the entire class. You should feel free, however, to communicate with your instructor via SNHU email at any time, particularly when you want to discuss something of a personal or sensitive nature. Your instructor will generally provide a response within 24 hours. Instructors will post grades and feedback (as applicable) within seven days of an assignment's due date, or within seven days of a late submission.

Grade Distribution

Assignment Category	Number of Graded Items	Point Value per Item	Total Points
Discussions	3	25	75
Assignments	4	30	120
Journal	1	25	25
Activities	5	45	225
Quizzes	4	40	160
zyBooks Participation Activities	3	5	15
zyBooks Challenge Activities	3	5	15
Project	1	350	350
Portfolio	1	15	15
			Total Course Points: 1,000

This course may also contain non-graded activities. The purpose of these non-graded activities is to assist you in mastering the learning outcomes in the graded activity items listed above.

University Grading System: Graduate

Grade	Numerical Equivalent	Points
A	93–100	4.00
A-	90–92	3.67
B+	87–89	3.33
B	83–86	3.00
B-	80–82	2.67
C+	77–79	2.33
C	73–76	2.00
F	0–72	0.00
I	Incomplete	

Grade	Numerical Equivalent	Points
IF	Incomplete/Failure *	
W	Withdrawn	

* Please refer to the [policy page](#) for information on the incomplete grade process.

Grading Guides

Specific activity directions, grading guides, posting requirements, and additional deadlines can be found in the Assignment Information section of the course.

Weekly Assignment Schedule

All readings can be found within each module of the course, and assignment instructions can be found in the Assignment Information section of the course. Assignments and discussion posts during the first week of each term are due by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time. Assignments and discussion posts for the remainder of the term are due by 11:59 p.m. of the student's local time zone.

Module	Topics and Assignments
One	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module One 1-1 Discussion: Data and Decisions: What's the Connection? 1-2 Assignment: Clean Enough to Trust?
Two	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Two 2-1 Participation Activity: zyBooks 2-2 Challenge Activity: zyBooks 2-3 Activity: Clean It, Code It, Frame It 2-4 Quiz
Three	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Three 3-1 Assignment: From Raw to Ready: Preprocessing and Blending Data 3-2 Activity: Clean and Merge Data for Modeling
Four	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Four 4-1 Participation Activity: zyBooks 4-2 Challenge Activity: zyBooks 4-3 Assignment: Comparing Visualizations for Impact 4-4 Discussion: Data Visualization in Healthcare Policy: Balancing Complexity With Clarity

Module	Topics and Assignments
Five	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Five 5-1 Participation Activity: zyBooks 5-2 Challenge Activity: zyBooks 5-3 Activity: Visualize the Insight: Exploring Patterns With Python 5-4 Quiz
Six	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Six 6-1 Quiz 6-2 Activity: Advanced Data Visualization With Python
Seven	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Seven 7-1 Activity: Data Exploration and Visualization for Insights 7-2 Assignment: Understanding Exploratory and Explanatory Analysis
Eight	Reading: <i>Data Literacy and Visualization</i> , Module Eight 8-1 Discussion: Stakeholder Simulation for Real-World Impact 8-2 Quiz
Nine	9-1 Project: From Data to Decisions: Exploring and Presenting Meaningful Insights
Ten	10-1 Journal: Visualizing Your Journey 10-2 GitHub Portfolio

Course Participation

Course participation is required within the first week of the term for all online courses.

Participation in this context is defined as completing one graded assignment during the first week of the course. Otherwise, students will be administratively removed for nonparticipation. Students who do not participate during the first week may forfeit their rights to be reinstated into the course. Students who stop attending a course after the first week and who do not officially withdraw will receive a grade calculated based on all submitted and missed graded assignments for the course. Missed assignments will earn a grade of zero. See the [course withdrawal policy](#) and the [course participation policy](#) for further information.

Late Assignments

Students who need extra time may submit assignments (excluding discussion board postings) up to one week after the assignment due date. Discussion board submissions will not be accepted for credit after the deadline except in extenuating circumstances.

- A penalty of 10 percent of the total value of the assignment will be applied to the grade achieved on the late assignment regardless of the day of the week on which the work is submitted.
- Students who submit assignments more than one week late will receive a grade of zero on the assignment unless they have made prior arrangements with the instructor.

Students must submit all assignments no later than 11:59 p.m. (in their own time zone) on the last day of the term. No assignments are accepted after the last day of the term unless an incomplete has been submitted. See the [incomplete grades policy](#).

There may be times an instructor makes an exception to the late assignment policy. Instructors may accept late work, including discussion board posts, with or without prior arrangement.

- Exceptions to the late policy on these grounds are left to the instructor's discretion, including whether the late penalty is applied or waived. Students should not assume that they will be allowed to submit assignments after the due dates.
- If an instructor finds that they are unable to determine whether an exception to the late policy would be appropriate without documentation, the collection and review of student documentation should be handled through the Dispute Resolution team in order to protect the student's privacy. In these cases, students should file a [Student Concern Dispute form](#) to have the circumstances reviewed.

If a student is experiencing (or knows they will experience) a circumstance, including pregnancy, that is protected under the Americans with Disabilities Act or Title IX, they are encouraged to contact the [Online Accessibility Center \(OAC\)](#) as soon as possible to explore what academic accommodations might be offered. Instructors must honor all deadlines established through the OAC.

Student Handbook

Review the [student handbook](#).

The student handbook applies to all registered domestic and international undergraduate, graduate, full-time, and part-time students, whether taking classes on campus or online in any program, including competency-based or continuing education programs. All students are expected to familiarize themselves with the language of the handbook, including the student code of conduct, which outlines the university's behavioral expectations, including on- and off-

campus behavior, and the university's academic integrity policy, which includes expectations and standards relating to coursework. The university reserves the right to make changes to the handbook as necessary without prior notice.

ADA/504 Compliance Statement

Southern New Hampshire University (SNHU) is dedicated to providing equal access to individuals with disabilities in accordance with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 and with Title III of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990, as amended by the Americans with Disabilities Act Amendments Act (ADAAA) of 2008.

SNHU prohibits unlawful discrimination on the basis of disability and takes action to prevent such discrimination by providing reasonable accommodations to eligible individuals with disabilities. The university has adopted the [ADA/504 Grievances Policy](#) (version 1.2 effective October 16, 2017), providing for prompt and equitable resolution of complaints regarding any action prohibited by Section 504 or the ADA.

For further information on accessibility support and services, visit the [Disability and Accessibility Services](#) webpage.

Academic Integrity Policy

Southern New Hampshire University requires all students to adhere to high standards of integrity in their academic work. Activities such as plagiarism and cheating are not condoned by the university. Review the [full academic integrity policy](#).

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Usage Guidelines

We recognize there are a variety of generative AI programs available to assist in your work. Generative AI programs are not a replacement for human creativity, originality, or critical thinking. However, within limited circumstances, and with proper citation, generative AI may be used as a tool in this course.

Review [these discipline-specific AI guidelines](#) for details on using AI tools in this course.

Copyright Policy

Southern New Hampshire University abides by the provisions of United States Copyright Act (Title 17 of the United States Code). Any person who infringes the copyright law is liable. Review the [full copyright policy](#).

Use of Open Educational Materials

Students may encounter openly licensed learning materials such as open access (OA) publications and open educational resources (OERs) in their courses. Southern New Hampshire University uses these openly licensed materials in compliance with the stated license terms on the material. Students must also ensure that any uses outside of this course follow the license terms of the material. The selection of these materials adheres to SNHU's accepted guidelines on course material adoption.

Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) to Generate Content

This course may contain some material created with the help of AI tools. Any AI-generated content has been thoroughly vetted by a team of instructional designers, editors, subject matter experts, and deans. Revisions have been made to ensure accuracy and clarity.

Withdrawal Policy

Review the [full withdrawal policy](#).

Southern New Hampshire University Policies

More information about SNHU policies can be found on the [policy page](#).